

Absolutely — **government** is a strong target because your passage uses it adjectivally inside **government secondary school**, while the noun itself has several important modern meanings involving **the ruling administration, the system/process of governing, public-sector bodies, and related family forms such as govern, governance, governmental, governor**.

Word family: **government / govern / governing / governance / governmental / governor**

Base word: government

Related forms: govern, governing, governance, governmental, governor

Useful compounds: government school, government department, government agency, government policy, local government, central government, government bond

Part of speech: mainly noun (名詞) / attributive noun modifier (名詞作修飾語) / related verb and adjective forms

Your sentence:

> “He taught at the **government secondary school** I attended from Form One to Form Six...”

Here, **government** modifies **secondary school**.

It means:

> **a secondary school that is run, funded, or administered by the government/public authorities rather than being privately operated.**

繁體中文：

由政府 / 公共機構開辦、資助或管理的中學

Natural translation:

> “He taught at the government secondary school I attended...”

「他在我就讀的那間**官立 / 政府中學**任教。」

Cambridge distinguishes **government** as the official ruling group and as the system/activity of governing, which supports the main lexical split below. ([劍橋詞典][1])

1. **government + school/department/agency (公共機構)** — 政府的；由政府營辦 / 管理的

This is your exact original sense.

Practice 1 — Original

> “He taught at a **government secondary school**.”

「他在一間**官立 / 政府中學**任教。」

Practice 2

> “She works for a **government department**.”

「她在一個**政府部門**工作。」

Practice 3

> “The programme is funded by a **government agency**.”

「這項計劃由一個**政府機構**資助。」

government + noun = 與政府所有、管理、資助或官方職能有關的

This is not a separate adjective lexeme in the same way as **governmental**; here **government** is a noun used attributively.

2. **government = ruling group/administration (執政政府) — 政府 ; 執政當局**

A major noun meaning.

Practice 4

> “The **government** announced a new education policy.”

「**政府**公布了一項新的教育政策。」

Practice 5

> “The new **government** took office after the election.”

「新一屆**政府 / 執政班子**在選舉後上任。」

government = 在某個國家 / 地區正式掌握行政權並負責制定、執行公共政策的一組人 / 機構

Cambridge defines this sense as the group officially controlling a country. ([劍橋詞典][2])

3. **government = system/form of governing (政體 / 治理制度) — 政體 ; 政府制度 ; 治理方式
**

A genuinely different meaning.

Practice 6

> “The country has a democratic form of **government**.”

「這個國家採用民主**政體 / 政府制度**。」

Practice 7

> “Different societies have developed different systems of **government**.”

「不同社會發展出不同的**治理制度 / 政體**。」

government = 一個國家、城市或群體被統治、管理和作出公共決策的制度 / 方式

This is uncountable in many such uses. Cambridge separately lists government as the system used for controlling a country, city, or group. ([劍橋詞典][2])

4. **government** = activity/process of governing (治理活動) — 治理 ; 執政 ; 政府管理

Another abstract noun use.

Practice 8

> “Effective **government** requires clear institutions.”

「有效的**治理 / 政府管理**需要清晰的制度。」

Practice 9

> “The party had little experience of **government**.”

「該黨缺乏**執政 / 治理國家**的經驗。」

government = 實際管理國家、地區或公共事務的活動和過程

This overlaps with #3 but is worth distinguishing:

* system of government → 治理制度

* experience of government → 執政經驗

Cambridge explicitly separates the **system** from the **activities** involved in controlling a

country or group. ([劍橋詞典][2])

5. **local/central/federal government (政府層級) — 地方 / 中央 / 聯邦政府**

A major public-administration construction.

Practice 10

> “The project is funded by **local government**.”

「這個項目由**地方政府**資助。」

Practice 11

> “The decision was made by the **central government**.”

「這項決定由**中央政府**作出。」

local/central/federal government = 不同層級的公共行政機構 / 治理當局

Cambridge Business English lists central, federal, and local government as standard uses. ([劍橋詞典][3])

6. **government policy/law/spending (官方公共事務) — 政府政策 / 法規 / 開支**

A highly productive attributive use.

Practice 12

> “The company is affected by **government policy**.”

「這家公司受到**政府政策**影響。」

Practice 13

> “Government spending increased last year.”

「去年**政府開支**增加了。」

government + public-policy noun = 由政府制定、管理、支付或執行的公共事務

This belongs under the same attributive sense as #1.

7. ****govern + country/state (國家 / 地區) — 統治 ; 治理****

Now the family moves to the verb.

Practice 14

> “The country is ****governed**** by an elected parliament.”

「這個國家由民選議會****治理 / 統治****。」

Practice 15

> “The coalition ****governed**** for four years.”

「這個聯合政府****執政****了四年。」

****govern = 正式掌管一個國家、地區或政治單位並作出公共決策****

Cambridge defines ****govern**** as officially controlling a country. ([劍橋詞典][4])

8. ****govern + process/system/behaviour (規則 / 原則) — 規範 ; 支配 ; 決定.....如何運作****

A major figurative/abstract verb meaning.

Practice 16

> “Strict rules ****govern**** how examinations are conducted.”

「嚴格規則****規範****考試如何進行。」

Practice 17

> “Several principles ****govern**** the use of the system.”

「幾項原則****支配 / 規範****這個系統的使用方式。」

****govern = 以規則、原則或條件控制某件事情如何發生 / 運作****

Cambridge also lists this broader influence/control sense. ([劍橋詞典][4])

9. ****governing + body/party (管理 / 執政) — 管理的；執政的****

Practice 18

> “The ****governing body**** approved the new rules.”

「****管理機構 / 管治機構****批准了新規則。」

Practice 19

> “The ****governing party**** introduced the proposal.”

「****執政黨****提出了這項建議。」

****governing = 負責管理、控制或制定規則的****

This is a useful derived adjective/participle.

10. ****governance = way an organisation/country is managed — 治理；管治****

A very important modern academic/business family member.

Practice 20

> “Good ****governance**** requires transparency.”

「良好的****治理 / 管治****需要透明度。」

Practice 21

> “The company strengthened its corporate ****governance****.”

「公司加強了企業****管治****。」

****governance = 一個國家或機構在最高層如何被管理，以及相關制度、規則和決策架構****

Cambridge defines governance as the way organisations or countries are managed at the highest level and the systems for doing so. ([劍橋詞典][5])

11. ****corporate governance (商業) — 企業管治****

A major business compound.

Practice 22

> “Investors pay close attention to **corporate governance**.”

「投資者十分重視**企業管治**。」

Practice 23

> “Strong corporate governance can improve accountability.”

「良好的**企業管治**可以提高問責性。」

corporate governance = 公司高層決策、監督、問責和控制制度的整體架構

This is a specialized but very common modern use. ([劍橋詞典][5])

12. **governmental** = relating to government — 政府的；與政府有關的

Practice 24

> “The project requires **governmental approval**.”

「這個項目需要**政府批准**。」

Practice 25

> “Several **governmental institutions** were involved.”

「多個**政府機構**參與其中。」

governmental = 與政府、公共行政或政府機構有關的

Cambridge lists **governmental** as the adjective meaning “relating to government.” ([劍橋詞典][1])

Important distinction: **government** vs **governmental**

government + noun

very common:

- > government policy
- > government department
- > government school

governmental + noun

more formal and abstract:

- > governmental authority
- > governmental institutions

In ordinary English:

- > **government policy**

is usually more natural than:

- > **governmental policy**

So **governmental** is not simply a “better” adjective form.

13. **governor = person who governs a region/institution (管理者 / 地方首長) — 州長 ; 總督 ; 主管**

A useful family member, but its exact meaning depends heavily on the political/organisational system.

Practice 26

- > “The state **governor** signed the bill.”

「該州的**州長**簽署了法案。」

Practice 27

- > “The school’s board of **governors** reviewed the policy.”

「學校的**校董會 / 管理委員會**檢討了政策。」

governor = 負責管理某個地區、機構或組織的人 ; 具體職銜依制度而異

Because political structures differ by jurisdiction, Chinese translation must follow context rather than forcing one fixed equivalent.

14. **government bond (金融) — 政府債券 ; 公債**

A highly useful finance compound.

Practice 28

> “The fund invests mainly in **government bonds**.”

「這個基金主要投資於**政府債券 / 公債**。」

Practice 29

> “Government bond yields rose this week.”

「本星期**政府債券孳息率**上升。」

government bond = 政府向投資者借款時發行、承諾按條件還本付息的債務工具

Cambridge Business English defines government bonds as money borrowed by a government or the official security representing that borrowing. ([劍橋詞典][6])

Important distinction: **government vs state**

These often overlap, but they are not identical.

government

usually refers to:

- * the ruling administration;
- * the system/activity of governing.

state

can refer more broadly to:

- * the enduring political/legal entity;
- * its institutions;
- * a constituent region in some countries.

A **government** can change after an election while the **state** continues to exist.

Important distinction: **government vs administration**

government

broad:

the ruling authorities/institutions.

administration

can mean:

* management generally;

* in some contexts, a particular executive government.

In American political English, **the administration** often refers to the executive branch under a particular president, but **government** is broader.

Important distinction: **government vs governance**

government

= ruling body/system/activity.

governance

= **how** something is governed — structures, rules, accountability, decision-making.

Compare:

> “The government changed.”

= 執政政府改變了。

> “Governance improved.”

= 管治方式 / 制度改善了。

Important distinction: **govern vs manage**

govern

usually involves:

- * formal authority;
- * rules;
- * high-level control.

manage

broader:

handle day-to-day operations/resources.

> “The board governs the organisation.”

「董事會負責整體管治。」

> “The director manages daily operations.”

「主管管理日常運作。」

Important distinction: **govern vs rule**

govern

often neutral and institutional:
manage/control officially.

rule

can emphasize authority over a country/people and may sound more personal or monarchical depending on context.

> “The cabinet governs.”

> “The king ruled for thirty years.”

Not always interchangeable.

Important distinction: **government school vs private school**

In your passage:

government school

= publicly run/funded school

private school

= independently/private-sector run, usually not directly operated by government

The exact institutional meaning varies by education system, so the natural Chinese in your passage is:

> **官立中學 / 政府中學**

rather than a generic literal translation.

Countability note: **government**

Countable: ruling administration

> “Three governments signed the agreement.”

「三個政府簽署協議。」

Often uncountable: system/activity

> “democratic government”

「民主政體 / 民主治理」

> “experience of government”

「執政經驗」

This is a valuable MCQ distinction.

Family-extension sweep

After the full audit, the useful modern family includes:

* **government school/department/agency** = 政府 / 公共機構的

* **government — ruling group** = 政府 / 執政當局

* **government — system** = 政體 / 治理制度
 * **government — governing activity** = 治理 / 執政
 * **local/central/federal government** = 地方 / 中央 / 聯邦政府
 * **government policy/spending** = 政府政策 / 開支
 * **govern — political** = 統治 / 治理
 * **govern — rules/principles** = 規範 / 支配
 * **governing body/party** = 管理機構 / 執政黨
 * **governance** = 治理 / 管治
 * **corporate governance** = 企業管治
 * **governmental** = 與政府有關的
 * **governor** = 州長 / 總督 / 主管，依制度而定
 * **government bond** = 政府債券 / 公債

I would stop there rather than include remote or highly jurisdiction-specific political terminology.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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government + institution	由政府 / 公共機構開辦、資助、管理或屬於官方體系的
government — ruling group	正式掌握行政權並負責制定、執行公共政策的一組人 / 機構
government — system	國家、城市或群體被統治和管理的制度 / 方式
government — activity	實際管理公共事務和行使執政權的活動 / 過程
local/central/federal government	在不同政治層級行使公共行政權的政府
govern — political	正式掌管國家 / 地區並作出公共決策
govern — rule/control	由規則、原則或條件決定某事如何發生 / 運作
governing	負責管理、控制或制定規則的
governance	一個國家 / 機構如何被管理，以及相關制度和決策架構
corporate governance	公司高層監督、決策、問責和控制的制度架構
governmental	與政府、公共行政或政府機構有關的
governor	負責管理某個地區或機構的人；具體職銜依制度而異
government bond	政府向投資者借款所發行的債務工具 / 公債

For your original sentence

> “He taught at the **government secondary school** I attended from Form One to Form Six...”

The exact meaning is:

government = 表示該中學屬於政府 / 公共教育體系，由政府開辦、資助或直接管理

So:

> **government secondary school**

= **「官立中學 / 政府中學」**

Natural full translation:

> **「他在我由中一讀到中六的那間官立中學任教。」**

The key learner distinction is:

> **the government** → 執政政府 / 政府當局

> **a system of government** → 政體 / 治理制度

> **government school** → 政府營辦 / 管理的學校

> **governance** → 如何治理 / 管治

> **govern** → 統治、治理或規範

[1]: https://dictionary.cambridge.org/dictionary/learner-english/government?utm_source=chatgpt.com "GOVERNMENT | meaning - Cambridge Learner's Dictionary"

[2]: https://dictionary.cambridge.org/dictionary/english/government?q=government_1&utm_source=chatgpt.com "GOVERNMENT | English meaning - Cambridge Dictionary"

[3]: https://dictionary.cambridge.org/us/dictionary/english/government?utm_source=chatgpt.com "GOVERNMENT | definition in the Cambridge English Dictionary"

[4]: https://dictionary.cambridge.org/dictionary/learner-english/govern?utm_source=chatgpt.com "GOVERN | meaning - Cambridge Learner's Dictionary"

[5]: https://dictionary.cambridge.org/dictionary/english/governance?utm_source=chatgpt.com "GOVERNANCE | English meaning - Cambridge Dictionary"

[6]: https://dictionary.cambridge.org/dictionary/english/government-bond?utm_source=chatgpt.com "GOVERNMENT BOND | English meaning - Cambridge Dictionary"